MIL-H-44159A
31 March 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-44159
13 February 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HAM CHUNKS, WITH JUICES, CANNED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers ham chunks with juices, canned for use by the Department of Defense.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specifications For

Beneficial comments, (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Room 1120, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

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3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Ham. The ham shall be of high commercial quality and shall be offered in the chilled state as smoked, fully-cooked, cured ham. The ham shall not be labeled "water-added" and shall not contain dextrose. The ham shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling. Coarse-textured dark meat or presence of shank meat shall cause rejection of the lot. The ham shall be maintained at a temperature not to exceed 40°F prior to preparation and further processing.

3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. The whole, smoked, boneless ham shall be trimmed to comply with the limitations listed in tables I and II. Ham shall be trimmed of fat to a degree necessary to assure compliance with finished product fat requirements. All ham shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA , Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) certificate to certify condition of the product and compliance with boning and trimming requirements.

3.2.2 Water. Water used for formulation, blanching, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of ham chunks. The ham shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings of 2.5 by 2.5 by 1 inch. The chunks shall be heated in a steam-jacketed kettle at a temperature and time to insure appropriate percent cook out in order to meet finished product drained weight requirements. The broth shall be drained from the cooked ham. Immediately after heating, the ham chunks and broth shall be utilized in the can filling and sealing (see 3.4). If this cannot be accomplished immediately, the cooked ham chunks and broth shall be cooled down and maintained at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for not more than 4 hours prior to can filling and sealing.

3.4 Can filling, sealing. Each can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The ham chunks and broth shall be filled into the cans. Water may be added as needed to each can in order to meet the finished product requirements.

b. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 5 inches of mercury.

c. The filled and sealed cans shall be in the retort process within 1 hour after sealing.

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3.5 Can thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. At least 75 percent of the ham chunks shall be 2.5 by 2.5 by 1 inch in size.

e. There shall be no ham chunk consisting entirely of fat.

f. No individual can shall contain less than 16.0 ounces, drained weight, of ham chunks.

g. The texture of the ham shall not be dry, rubbery, tough or mushy.

h. The average net weight shall be not less than 29.0 ounces.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 28.5 ounces of product.

j. The average fat content shall not be greater than 15.0 percent.

k. The fat content of any individual can shall not be greater than 17.0 percent.

l. The salt content of any individual can shall be not less than 1.5 percent nor greater than 2.50 percent.

m. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The ham component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

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3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ham examination for condition. All ham shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition requirements in 3.2.1. Any nonconforming ham shall be rejected.

4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed ham examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing, the ham shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of hams shall be declared to the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be one ham. The sample size shall be as specified in table I. Failure of the ham to meet the acceptance criteria as [illegible] table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for ham

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rejected because of not being in excellent condition, the ham may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Ham shall not be reexamined more than one time. For examination, each ham selected as a sample unit shall be divided into pieces by straight cuts made perpendicular to the cutting table surface and at an approximate right angle to the long axis of the ham. The cuts shall be made randomly across the surface, however, no piece shall be more than 1.5 or less than 1 inch in width. Examination shall be made on the right-hand surfaces exposed by these cuts. The pieces resulting from this examination may be included for processing into the end item.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed ham

Lot size (hams)	Sample size (hams)	Defect category Major AC	Major RE
500 or less	5	0	1
501 to 35,000	20	1	2
35,001 or more	32	2	3

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed ham defects 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
102	Presence of cartilage measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
103	Presence of skin measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
104	Presence of popliteal, prescapular, prefemoral or any exposed lymph gland measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
105	Presence of blood clot or bruise measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed ham defects 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
106	Presence of one or more pale or soft areas 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
107	Surface or seam fat measuring more than 0.3 inch in thickness.
108	Presence of uncured or uncooked areas 0.5 inch or more in size dimension.

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operation employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

3/ Defects may be cut from sliced surfaces to measure all dimensions.

4/ No defect shall be scored more than once per ham.

4.5.1.3 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.4 Unfilled can inspection. Conformance of unfilled cans to the requirements specified in 5.1.1 shall be determined by examination of certificates of conformance or of other valid documents. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the can lot or of any involved product.

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4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each filled can in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 29.0 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 28.5 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.4 Product examination. Randomly select eight filled and sealed cans from those used in the net weight examination. The filled and sealed cans shall be examined for can vacuum examination (see 4.5.6) prior to product examination. The sample cans shall be heated for at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and examined for the defects listed in table III. The finding of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE III. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of ham chunks in a can is less than 16.0 ounces. 3/
102	Chunk consisting entirely of fat.
103	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).
104	Ham chunks are dry, rubbery, tough, or mushy.
105	Ham chunk greater than 2.5 by 2.5 by 1 inch in size.
106	Twenty-five percent of the ham chunks less than 2.5 by 2.5 by 1 inch in size.

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1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, paper, paint, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off. The remaining contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat without breaking the ham chunks. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/2 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the ham chunks. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4.5.5 Fat and salt content testing. The product shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Fosslet Method or the Crude Fat or Ether Extract Method (using petroleum ether) in the Meat and Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, and for salt content in accordance with the Meat and Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any individual result failing to conform to the requirements in 3.6(k and l) shall be classified as a major defect. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the average fat content fails to conform to the requirement in 3.6(j). The sampling and acceptance criteria shall be as specified in table IV.

TABLE IV. Sampling plan for fat and salt content testing.

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 1200	3	0	1
Over 1201	13	1	2

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4.5.6 Can vacuum examination. The filled and sealed cans selected for the product examination (see 4.5.4) shall be examined for vacuum. The cans and contents shall be allowed to reach 70° to 80°F. The vacuum reading shall be taken with a puncture-type vacuum gauge making the puncture as near as possible to the double seam to minimize error due to distortion of the end. A correction of 1 inch of vacuum shall be added to the gauge reading for each 1000 feet above sea level at which the determination is made. Failure of any can to meet the vacuum requirement shall cause rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed cans shall be in accordance with the U. S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

Level C shipping containers shall be examined only for the marking, arrangement, and number of can defects specified above and for the closure method specified in 5.2.3.

4.5.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A net weight of 29.0 ounces of product shall be unit packed into an open-top style, round metal can, size 401 by 411, with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate. The base plate of the can shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating.

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The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect or be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I or, when specified (see 6.1), type III of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate provided the cans have an exterior commercial coating.

5.2 Packing. Twenty-four cans, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed on end four in length, three in width and two in depth within a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Twenty-four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width interior dimensions of the box. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Twenty-four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except the closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with Method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width interior dimensions of the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

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5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

5.4.2 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. When type III exterior coating of cans is required (see 5.1.1).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Food processing
Ham
Ration
Thermostabilized

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-44159A	Ham Chunks, with Juices, Canned

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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